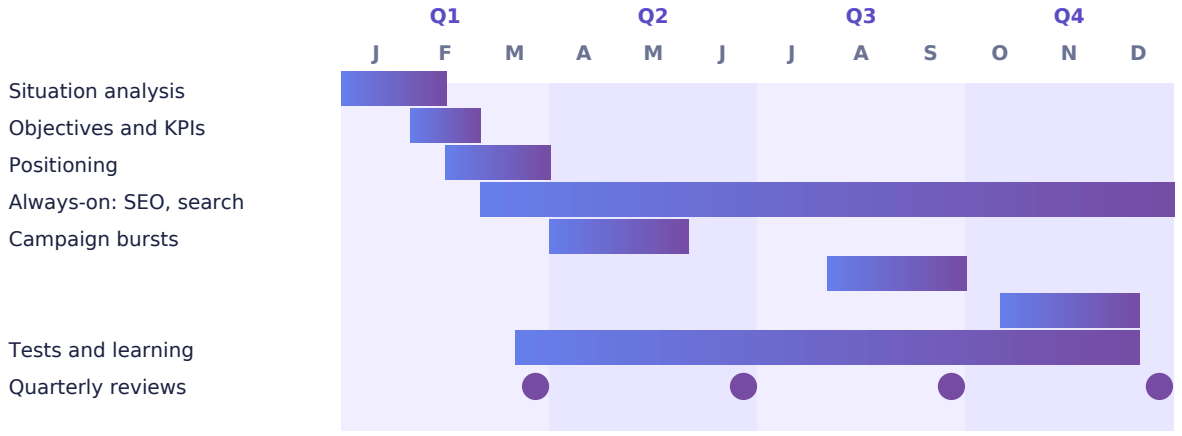
WEEK 17 · DIGITAL MARKETING & AI BOOTCAMP

Digital Marketing Strategy

Analyse the market, choose your position and build a 12-month plan

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12-month strategy roadmap



Inside this guide

1 Strategy vs tactics
2 The SOSTAC framework
3 Other frameworks and fit
4 Objectives, goals and KPIs
5 Market: PESTLE for Mauritius
6 Customer research
7 Digital audit with GA4
8 SWOT and the 5C
9 Competitive analysis steps
10 Free competitor tools
11 Competitor matrix and map
12 Segmentation and targeting
13 Personas and JTBD
14 Value proposition canvas
15 Positioning statement
16 Brand and messaging
17 Choosing channels
18 Budgeting methods
19 Budget allocation in Rs
20 Calendar for Mauritius
21 Measurement and dashboards
22 Testing roadmap
23 Team, partners and tools
24 Governance and risk
25 AI in strategy
26 Presenting the strategy
27 Case studies: hotel, B2B
28 FAQ
29 Exercises and 12-month plan
30 Glossary and checklists

PART A

Foundations

Strategy versus tactics, the SOSTAC planning framework and objectives you can measure

SECTION 1

Strategy vs tactics: why a plan matters

For sixteen weeks you have learned the tools of digital marketing: websites and analytics, SEO, content, social media, Google Ads, Meta Ads, display and video, email and CRM, AI and automation, e-commerce and conversion. This week you learn to decide **which** of those tools a business should use, for **whom**, with **how much money** and in **what order**. That decision is a strategy.

What strategy is (and is not)

A **digital marketing strategy** is a set of choices that explains how marketing will help the business reach its goals. It answers five questions: where are we now, where do we want to be, who are we going to serve, why should they choose us, and how will we reach them with the money and people we have. **Tactics** are the specific actions that carry out those choices: a Google Search campaign, a Reel series, a welcome email, a winter offer.



	Strategy	Tactics
Question it answers	Why, who, where, how much	What, how, when
Time horizon	12 months or more	Days, weeks, a campaign
How often it changes	Reviewed every quarter, rewritten yearly	Adjusted every week
Example (cake shop)	Become the first choice for custom birthday cakes in the Plaines Wilhems area, with online ordering	Instagram Reels of cake reveals, Google Search ads for "birthday cake Rose Hill", WhatsApp order button
Example (accounting firm)	Win small companies that struggle with VAT and payroll compliance	LinkedIn articles on VAT changes, a free compliance checklist, a webinar, follow-up emails

Signs that a business has tactics but no strategy

- "We post every day" but nobody can say which customers the posts are for or what they should do next.

- Ads are boosted when sales are slow, then stopped, with no record of what worked.
- Every new platform is tried (TikTok, Threads, a chatbot) because a competitor did it.
- The budget is "whatever is left this month".
- Reports show likes and reach, but not bookings, leads or revenue.
- Each team member has a different answer to "who is our ideal customer?"

Why a 12-month plan

A year is long enough to build assets that compound (a website that ranks, an email list, reviews, a brand people search for) and short enough to stay realistic. In Mauritius a 12-month plan also lets you prepare for the moments that shape demand: the tourism high season, school holidays, Divali, the end-of-year bonus, the cyclone season. You will plan the year in quarters, with a detailed plan for the next 90 days and lighter plans for the rest, then review every quarter.

> **This week's deliverable:** a **12-Month Strategy Document** for a real or realistic business: market analysis, competitive analysis, positioning and a 12-month plan with budget and KPIs. It is also the starting point of your Week 20 capstone, so choose a business you know well. Section 29 gives the full template.

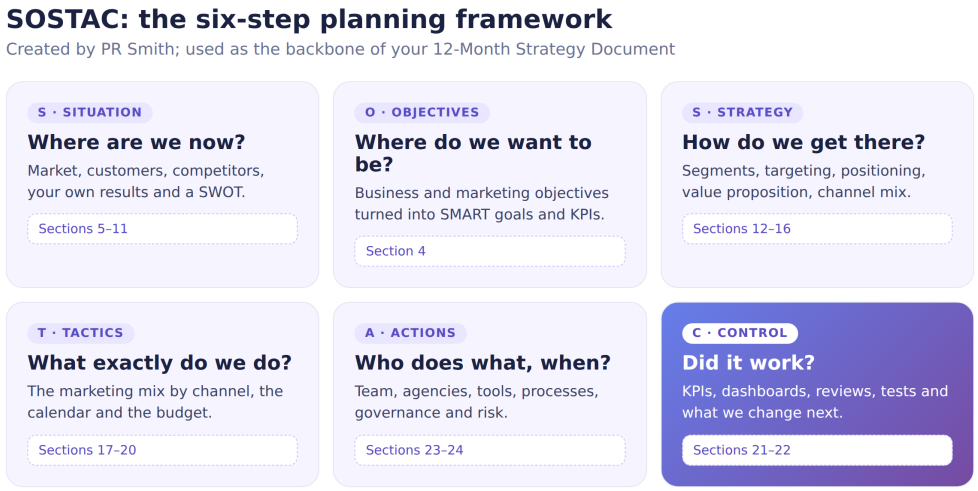
A strategy is a set of choices, including what you will not do

Small businesses rarely fail for lack of ideas; they fail because they try to do everything with a small budget. A good strategy concentrates resources where the business can win. Saying "this year we will not do TikTok and will not target students" is as important as saying what you will do.

SECTION 2

The SOSTAC planning framework

A framework is a checklist that makes sure you think about everything in the right order. The most widely taught framework for marketing plans is **SOSTAC**, created by PR Smith in the 1990s and still used by companies of all sizes. This guide, and your deliverable, follow its six steps.



The six steps in practice

Step	Key questions	Outputs in your document
Situation analysis	Who are our customers? What is happening in the market? How do we compare with competitors? What do our numbers say?	PESTLE, customer insights, digital audit, competitor matrix, SWOT
Objectives	What does the business need? What must marketing deliver, by when?	3–5 SMART goals and their KPIs
Strategy	Which segments do we target? How do we position ourselves? Which channels and stages matter most?	Target segments, personas, value proposition, positioning statement, channel strategy
Tactics	What will we do in each channel, each month? What will it cost?	Channel plan, 12-month calendar, budget table
Actions	Who does what? With which tools and partners? What could go wrong?	Team and roles, tool stack, governance, risk register
Control	How will we know it works? When do we review and change?	KPI tree, dashboard plan, testing roadmap, review rhythm

> **Tip:** a popular memory aid adds "3 Ms" for resources: **Men and women** (people and skills), **Money** (budget) and **Minutes** (time). Check each SOSTAC step against all three: a beautiful plan that needs four full-time people is not a plan for a two-person business.

SOSTAC is a loop, not a line

The control step feeds the next situation analysis. After each quarter you look at the results, update the situation, adjust the objectives if needed and change tactics. That is why your document will include a quarterly review (Section 21).

SECTION 3

Other frameworks and how they fit

You will meet other frameworks in articles, agencies and job interviews. They do not compete with SOSTAC: most of them describe the customer journey or how to set goals, and slot inside the SOSTAC steps.

How the main frameworks fit together

One planning structure (SOSTAC), one customer-journey lens (See-Think-Do-Care or RACE), one goal system (OKRs or SMART)

	Reach / See	Act / Think	Convert / Do	Engage / Care
RACE (Smart Insights)	Build awareness and visits	Interactions, leads, sign-ups	Sales and bookings, online or offline	Repeat, loyalty, advocacy
See-Think-Do-Care	Everyone who could ever buy	People with a need, not ready yet	People ready to buy now	Existing customers
Typical channels	Social video, display, PR, creators	SEO content, email sign-up, retargeting	Search ads, offers, WhatsApp, website	Email, CRM, loyalty, reviews
Typical KPIs	Reach, views, new users	Engagement rate, leads, sign-ups	Key events, sales, CPA, ROAS	Repeat rate, reviews, CLV

SOSTAC sits around all of this: the **Situation** shows where each stage is weak, the **Strategy** decides which stages matter most this year, and **Control** measures every stage.

Framework	What it is	Where it fits in SOSTAC
RACE (Smart Insights)	Plan, Reach, Act, Convert, Engage: a digital customer lifecycle with KPIs at each stage.	Strategy and control: organise channels and KPIs by stage
See-Think-Do-Care (Avinash Kaushik)	Audiences grouped by intent: anyone who could buy, people with a need, people ready now, existing customers.	Strategy: decide content and budget per intent stage (used in Section 17)
Funnel and flywheel	The funnel shows people dropping out stage by stage; the flywheel shows happy customers bringing in new ones.	Strategy: balance acquisition and retention
OKRs	Objectives and Key Results: an inspiring objective plus 2–4 measurable results, set each quarter.	Objectives and control: a goal system that fits quarterly reviews
STP	Segmentation, Targeting, Positioning.	Strategy (Sections 12–15)
PESTLE, SWOT, 5C	Analysis tools for the outside world, your position and the overall context.	Situation (Sections 5–8)

Which one should you use?

For your 12-Month Strategy Document, use **SOSTAC as the structure**, **See-Think-Do-Care (or RACE) to plan channels and KPIs by stage**, and **SMART goals** for objectives, with optional **OKRs** for each quarter. That combination is common in agencies and easy for a manager to follow.

A quarterly OKR example

```
Objective (Q2 2027): Make Kaz Corail the obvious winter escape for Mauritian couples
  KR1: 120 resident bookings between May and June (2026: 70)
  KR2: 2,500 sign-ups to the "Winter Escapes" WhatsApp and email list
  KR3: Cost per resident booking under Rs 900
  KR4: 40 new Google reviews mentioning "weekend" or "couple"
```

Kaz Corail Boutique Hotel is the fictional running example in this guide: a 28-room hotel in Grand Baie. The second running example, ClearBooks Advisory, is a fictional accounting and payroll firm in Ebène that sells to small companies (B2B, business-to-business). All their numbers are illustrative.

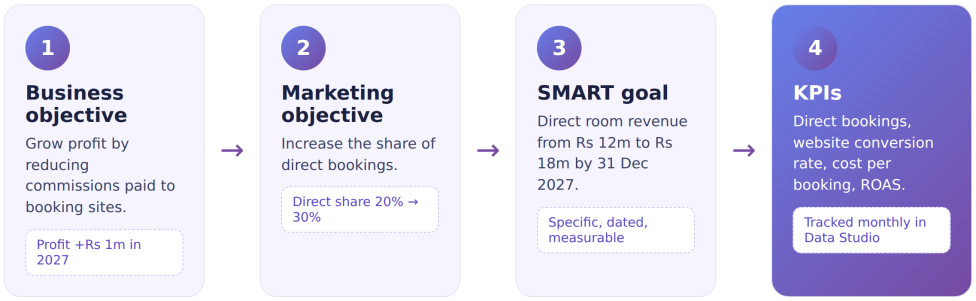
SECTION 4

Objectives, SMART goals and KPIs

Objectives connect marketing to the business. Without them, there is no way to choose between options or to judge results. The cascade below starts from what the owner or manager needs and ends with the numbers you track every month.

The objectives cascade

Every KPI should trace back to a business result (example: Kaz Corail Boutique Hotel, fictional)



Four levels, four different questions

Level	Question	Kaz Corail (B2C)	ClearBooks Advisory (B2B)
Business objective	What does the business need?	Profit +Rs 1m by paying less commission to booking sites	30 new retainer clients in 2027
Marketing objective	What must marketing change?	Raise direct bookings from 20% to 30% of room revenue	Generate enough qualified leads for sales to win 30 clients
SMART goal	Exactly how much, by when?	Direct room revenue from Rs 12m to Rs 18m by 31 Dec 2027	120 sales-qualified leads (SQLs) at under Rs 4,000 each by 31 Dec 2027
KPIs	What do we track to steer?	Direct bookings, booking conversion rate, cost per booking, ROAS	Leads, lead-to-SQL rate, cost per SQL, win rate, pipeline value

Writing SMART goals

SMART means **S**pecific, **M**easurable, **A**chievable, **R**elevant and **T**ime-bound. "Get more followers" is not a goal. "Increase online cake orders from 40 to 70 a month by June 2027 while keeping the cost per order under Rs 150" is.

Weak goal	SMART version
Grow on Instagram	Reach 15,000 local accounts a month and 250 profile visits a week from Reels by March 2027, to support the online order goal
More leads	40 qualified B2B leads a month from LinkedIn and the website by Q3 2027, at under Rs 1,500 per lead
Improve the website	Raise the mobile booking conversion rate from 1.2% to 2.0% by September 2027 (Week 16 methods)
Be famous	Double monthly branded searches ("Kaz Corail", "Kaz Corail Grand Baie") in Google Search Console by December 2027

Choosing KPIs that matter

- **One North Star metric**: the single number that best reflects value for the business (direct room revenue, monthly paying clients, online orders). Everything else supports it.
- **3–6 KPIs**: a mix of **leading indicators** (they move first and predict results: sessions, leads, add-to-carts) and **lagging indicators** (they confirm results later: revenue, retention).
- **Efficiency KPIs** that protect profit: cost per acquisition (CPA), return on ad spend (ROAS = revenue ÷ ad spend), customer lifetime value (CLV) compared with acquisition cost (Week 12).
- **Health metrics** you watch but do not target: reach, engagement rate, email open rate. They warn you of problems.

> **Vanity metrics:** likes, followers and impressions are easy to grow and easy to buy, but they rarely pay the bills. Keep them in the report only when you can show how they lead to a business result.

Setting realistic targets

Start from your own baseline (last 12 months in GA4, your ad accounts and your sales records), add what the planned changes could realistically add, and check against benchmarks from Weeks 6–16. A good target is ambitious but believable: if the team thinks it is impossible, they stop trying. When you have no history, set a learning goal for the first quarter ("measure our real conversion rate") and fix the target after 90 days.

> **In Mauritius:** many small businesses do not track revenue by channel. Before writing targets, spend an afternoon collecting the basics: monthly sales for the last year, where customers came from (ask them), and what was spent on ads. Even rough numbers are better than none, and the gap itself becomes an action in your plan (set up key events in GA4, record the lead source in the CRM).

PART B

Situation analysis

The market, your customers, your own numbers and your competitors: where are we now?

SECTION 5

The market: PESTLE for Mauritius

The situation analysis starts outside the business. PESTLE looks at six forces you cannot control but must plan around: Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal and Environmental. Keep only the points that change a marketing decision; a list of general facts impresses nobody.



Mauritius in numbers (check for updates before you present)

Indicator	Latest figure	What it means for marketers
Population	About 1.27 million (UN data, October 2025)	A small market: you will reach the same people often, so creative fatigue and reputation matter
Internet users	1.01 million, 79.5% of the population (October 2025)	Most adults are reachable online, but about 1 in 5 people are not: keep offline touchpoints for older customers
Social media user identities	886,000, 69.9% of the population (late 2025)	Facebook remains the widest-reach platform; identities are not the same as unique people
Instagram ad reach	418,000 (33.0%)	Younger and urban audiences; strong for food, fashion, hospitality
LinkedIn members	630,000 registered (49.7%)	Useful for B2B and recruitment; registered members are not monthly users
Tourist arrivals	1,436,250 in 2025 (+3.9%); Europe about 64% of arrivals in early 2026	Hotels and tourism businesses market to Europe, Réunion, India and South Africa as well as residents
Economy	Growth forecasts around 3% for 2026; inflation projected above 5% (Bank of Mauritius, mid-2026)	Households watch prices: value, instalments and promotions get attention

Sources: DataReportal Digital 2026 Mauritius; Statistics Mauritius tourism data reported in January 2026; CareEdge Mauritius Economic Update, June 2026 (quoting Statistics Mauritius and the Bank of Mauritius).

The legal points every Mauritian strategy should mention

- **Data Protection Act 2017 (DPA 2017):** collect personal data with a lawful basis (often consent for marketing), say why you collect it, keep it secure, and honour requests to access or delete it. Controllers must register with the Data Protection Office, and personal data breaches must be reported to it (generally within 72 hours). If you target EU residents, the EU GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation) also applies (Weeks 10 and 15).
- **VAT on foreign digital services:** since 1 January 2026, non-resident suppliers of digital services to Mauritius (including advertising services) must register for VAT and charge the standard 15% rate. When you budget for Meta, Google, LinkedIn or software subscriptions billed from abroad, check whether VAT is now added to the invoice and include it in your plan.
- **Consumer protection and advertising rules:** prices must be clear, promotions honest and claims ("best", "eco-friendly", "number 1") provable.
- **Platform policies** (Google, Meta, TikTok) for sensitive sectors such as health, finance, alcohol and gambling.

Social and cultural factors that shape campaigns

Mauritius is multilingual: French dominates the press and many brand communications, English is the language of administration and much of B2B, and Kreol Morisien is the language of everyday life and works very well in informal social content and WhatsApp. Festivals from several communities (Divali, Eid, Chinese Spring Festival, Christmas, Cavadee, Maha Shivaratree) create shopping peaks and require respectful, accurate creative. Word of mouth is powerful in a small island: one bad experience travels fast, and so does a great one.

> **Tip:** write each PESTLE point as "fact → so what for us". Example: "Inflation projected above 5% in 2026 → our family customers will compare prices more; lead with value bundles, not discounts that hurt margin."

SECTION 6

Customer research: listen before you plan

Your strategy is only as good as your understanding of customers. You do not need a big research budget: a mix of data you already have, short interviews and online listening gives a clear picture in one or two weeks.

Six low-cost research methods

Method	How to do it	What you learn	Time / cost
Customer interviews	5–8 calls of 20 minutes with recent customers and 2–3 people who did not buy	Real reasons, words they use, objections	1 week, free
Short survey	Google Forms, 5–8 questions, sent to your list or WhatsApp contacts, small thank-you	How common each reason is	2 weeks, free
Review mining	Read 50–100 Google, TripAdvisor or Facebook reviews of you and competitors; tag themes	What people praise and complain about	1 day, free
Search demand	Google Trends and the Keyword Planner (Weeks 3 and 6) for your main topics	Seasonality, interest by region, words people type	Half a day, free
Social listening	Comments, Facebook groups, Reddit, competitor posts	Questions, frustrations, trends	2–3 hours
Your own data	GA4, Search Console, CRM, sales records, WhatsApp chats	Who converts, from where, with what value	1 day

Good interview questions

1. "Tell me about the last time you needed [product/service]. What was going on?"
2. "What else did you consider? Why did you choose us (or not)?"
3. "What almost stopped you from buying?"
4. "Where did you look for information? Who did you ask?"
5. "If we disappeared tomorrow, what would you use instead?"
6. "What would make you recommend us to a friend?"

Ask about past behaviour, not opinions about the future: "Would you buy this?" produces polite yeses; "What did you buy last time?" produces facts. Record the exact words customers use; they become your ad headlines.

> **In Mauritius:** offer interviews in English, French or Kreol so that people speak naturally, and keep surveys short and mobile-friendly: most answers will be given on a phone, often via a WhatsApp link. Under the DPA 2017, tell people why you collect their answers and do not add them to a marketing list unless they agree.

Turning research into insights

An insight is not a fact; it is a discovery about motivation that you can act on. Fact: "60% of our guests are couples." Insight: "Couples choose us because they want to feel like locals, not tourists, but our ads show the pool, like every other hotel." The second sentence changes your creative strategy.

SECTION 7

Your own numbers: the digital audit

The internal part of the situation analysis looks at what the business already has and how it performs. Use the analytics skills from Weeks 2 and 11 to produce a short, factual audit. It becomes your baseline for targets.

What to audit, and where to find it

Area	Check	Where
Results	Sales, leads or bookings per month for 12 months; revenue by channel if possible	Sales records, CRM, GA4 key events and revenue
Traffic	Users and sessions by channel; landing pages; device split; new vs returning	GA4 Reports: Acquisition, Engagement
Conversion	Conversion rate by channel and device; funnel drop-offs	GA4 funnel exploration (Week 11), booking engine
SEO	Clicks, impressions, top queries, branded vs non-branded, pages indexed	Google Search Console (Week 3)
Paid media	Spend, CPA, ROAS, best campaigns, wasted spend	Google Ads, Meta Ads Manager (Weeks 6–8, 12)
Social	Followers, reach, engagement rate, top posts, response time	Meta Business Suite, TikTok and LinkedIn analytics (Week 5)
Email / CRM	List size, growth, open and click rates, repeat purchase rate	Mailchimp, HubSpot, Brevo (Weeks 10 and 15)
Reputation	Rating and number of reviews vs competitors; recent themes	Google Business Profile, TripAdvisor, Facebook
Assets and skills	Content library, photos, brand guidelines, team skills, tools, contracts	Shared drives, team interviews

Using GA4 for the audit

1. Set the date range to the last 12 months and compare with the previous 12 months.
2. In **Reports › Acquisition › Traffic acquisition**, note sessions, engagement rate, key events and revenue by session default channel group.
3. In **Reports › Engagement › Landing page**, list the 10 pages that bring most sessions and their key event rate.
4. Add a comparison for mobile vs desktop; low mobile conversion is a frequent quick win.
5. If benchmarking is available for your property (it requires the "Modeling contributions & business insights" data-sharing setting), compare your engagement and acquisition metrics with your peer group.
6. Write three sentences: what is working, what is not, and what is missing from the tracking.

> **Check the data before you trust it.** Many small business accounts have broken or duplicated key events, missing UTM tags on email and WhatsApp links, or ad clicks counted as "Direct". If the data is unreliable, fixing tracking becomes action number one of your plan (Week 11).

Summarise the audit in a scorecard

Area	Score 1–5	Evidence	Priority
Website and conversion	2	Mobile booking rate 1.2%, slow booking engine	High
SEO	3	Ranks for brand only; 4 blog posts	Medium
Paid media	2	Boosted posts only, no conversion tracking	High
Reputation	5	4.7 on Google, 9.1 on booking sites	Leverage
CRM and email	1	Guest emails in the booking system, never used	High

Example scorecard for Kaz Corail (fictional, illustrative).

SECTION 8

SWOT and the 5C analysis

Once you have the outside view (PESTLE, customers, competitors) and the inside view (audit), you summarise them. SWOT is the best-known summary tool; the 5C analysis is a useful checklist to make sure nothing is missing.

SWOT: four boxes, two directions

Strengths and **weaknesses** are internal (things you control). **Opportunities** and **threats** are external (things happening around you). A common mistake is to write "Instagram" as an opportunity: Instagram is a channel; the opportunity is "Mauritian couples increasingly book short local breaks after seeing Reels from creators".

Strengths (internal, +)	Weaknesses (internal, –)
• Excellent reviews (4.7 Google, 9.1 booking sites) • Warm, multilingual staff • Location 5 minutes from Grand Baie centre • Authentic local food offer	• 80% of bookings via booking sites (high commission) • Slow, old booking engine; 1.2% mobile conversion • No CRM, no email marketing • Little brand awareness outside repeat guests
Opportunities (external, +)	**Threats (external, –)**
• Growth in arrivals from India, Italy and Spain in 2025 • Residents looking for short winter breaks • Travellers want authentic, small hotels • AI tools lower content production costs	• Big resorts with large budgets bidding on the same keywords • Higher fuel prices and airfares could slow tourism • Cyclones and heavy rain cause cancellations • Rising costs for staff and supplies

Kaz Corail SWOT (fictional). Arrival trends: Statistics Mauritius data for 2025; risks: CareEdge economic update, June 2026.

From SWOT to strategy: the TOWS questions

Combination	Question	Example strategic option
S + O	How can our strengths exploit opportunities?	Use our reviews and local food in Reels aimed at Italian and Indian couples
W + O	How can opportunities fix weaknesses?	Launch a resident winter offer to build an email list and CRM
S + T	How can strengths protect us from threats?	Compete with resorts on authenticity, not on price or ad budget
W + T	What must we fix to avoid the worst?	Replace the booking engine and add a flexible cancellation policy for cyclone season

The 5C checklist

C	Questions	Section
Company	Goals, strengths, resources, brand, current results	7
Customers	Who buys, why, how, how often, what they value	6, 12–14
Competitors	Who else solves the same need, how they compete	9–11
Collaborators	Partners, suppliers, distributors, creators, platforms (booking sites, marketplaces, delivery apps)	23
Context	The PESTLE factors: economy, law, technology, culture, climate	5

> **Tip:** limit each SWOT box to 4–6 points, ranked by importance, each backed by evidence from your research. A SWOT with 15 points per box is a brainstorm, not an analysis.

SECTION 9

Competitive analysis, step by step

Competitive analysis tells you what customers compare you with, where competitors are strong, and where there is space for you. It is the first practical exercise of this week (Exercise 17.1).



Step 1: list the right competitors

Type	Definition	Kaz Corail example	ClearBooks example
Direct	Same offer, same customers	Other boutique hotels in the north	Small accounting firms serving SMEs
Indirect	Different offer, same need	Large resorts, villas, guesthouses	Freelance accountants, payroll software
Substitute	Another way to solve the need	A holiday in Réunion or Seychelles, staying home	Owner does the books in Excel
Aspirational	Brands you want to learn from (any country)	A well-known boutique hotel group abroad	A leading SME accounting firm in another market

Find them the way customers do: search Google and Google Maps for your main keywords, check who advertises on them, look at the "People also search for" box, ask customers what else they considered, and check booking sites or marketplaces. Keep **3–5 competitors** for deep analysis.

Step 2: collect the evidence

What to look at	What to note
Offer and price	Products, packages, price level, promotions, guarantees, payment options
Website	Speed (PageSpeed Insights), clarity of the offer, booking or contact flow, languages, trust signals
Search visibility	Keywords they rank for, estimated traffic, content (Section 10)
Advertising	Active ads on Meta and Google, formats, messages, offers, how long ads have run
Social media	Platforms, posting frequency, formats, engagement, response to comments
Reputation	Rating, number of reviews, recent themes, how they reply
Positioning	The promise in their headline: who it is for and why they are different

Steps 3 to 5: score, map and decide

Score each competitor on the factors customers care about (Section 11), plot them on a **perceptual map** (two axes that matter to customers, such as price and "local experience") and then decide: where do we compete head-on, where do we avoid a fight, and which customer needs nobody serves well? The conclusion is short: three to five bullet points that feed your SWOT and positioning.

> **Stay ethical.** Use public information only. Do not pose as a customer to obtain confidential pricing, copy content, or misuse competitors' brand names in your ads (Google and Meta have trademark policies). Comparative claims must be true and provable.

SECTION 10

Free tools for competitor research

You can do serious competitive research without paying for tools. Each free tool has limits, and estimates for small Mauritian websites can be rough, so combine several sources and look for patterns rather than exact numbers.

Tool	What it shows (free)	Limits to know	Use it for
Meta Ad Library	All active ads of any Facebook or Instagram page, with start date, platforms and versions	No spend or results for normal (non-political) ads outside the EU	Messages, offers, formats; long-running ads are probably working
Google Ads Transparency Center	Ads served by an advertiser on Search, Display, Gmail and YouTube; filter by date and region	No keywords, budgets or results	Who advertises, which formats and messages
Google Trends	Relative search interest over time and by region; compare up to 5 terms	Index from 0 to 100, not volumes; small terms show no data in Mauritius	Seasonality, brand interest, rising topics
Similarweb (free search)	Estimated visits, traffic sources, top countries for a domain	Limited history; small sites may show no data	Rough size and channel mix of larger competitors
Semrush (free account)	Domain overview, organic keywords, backlinks	About 10 requests a day per main tool on the free plan	Keywords competitors rank for, content gaps
Ubersuggest (free)	Keyword ideas, domain overview, top pages	3 searches a day on the free plan	Quick checks on keywords and top pages
Google Keyword Planner	Search volume ranges and keyword ideas for Mauritius	Ranges without active spend (Week 6)	Demand for each product or service
PageSpeed Insights	Speed and Core Web Vitals of any URL	Lab and field data differ	Compare website experience
Google Maps and reviews	Ratings, review count and content	Manual reading	Reputation and service themes

Free plan limits checked in October 2026 (Semrush knowledge base and blog, Ubersuggest pricing reviews). Limits change; check before you rely on them.

A 90-minute research routine

1. **Meta Ad Library (15 min):** go to facebook.com/ads/library, choose country Mauritius (or All) and "All ads", type the competitor’s page name. Screenshot 3 typical ads and note how long the oldest one has been running.
2. **Google Ads Transparency Center (10 min):** search the competitor’s name or website, set the region to Mauritius, look at text and video ads.
3. **Google Trends (10 min):** compare brand names over 5 years in Mauritius; then compare category terms ("hotel Mauritius", "hôtel île Maurice") worldwide to see seasonality in source markets.
4. **Semrush or Ubersuggest (20 min):** enter each competitor domain, note estimated organic traffic, top 10 keywords and top pages.
5. **Website and speed (15 min):** open each site on your phone, try to book or enquire, run PageSpeed Insights.

6. **Reviews (20 min):** read the 20 most recent reviews of each; tag positive and negative themes.

> **In Mauritius:** many Mauritian businesses advertise mainly on Facebook and Instagram, so the Meta Ad Library is usually your richest source. Look at the language mix (French, English, Kreol) and at the call to action: you will often see "Send message" or WhatsApp ads rather than website traffic, which tells you how customers in that sector prefer to buy.

SECTION 11

The competitor matrix and perceptual map

The competitor matrix turns your research into a comparison you can read in one minute. Choose 6–10 factors that matter to customers (from your interviews and reviews), score each competitor from 1 (weak) to 5 (strong), and write one line of evidence for each score in a separate sheet.

Example: Kaz Corail and three northern competitors (fictional)

Factor (weight)	Kaz Corail	Hotel A (resort)	Hotel B (boutique)	Villa C (rental)
Price level (Rs per night, double)	Rs 7,500–9,500	Rs 14,000+	Rs 8,000–10,000	Rs 6,000
Reviews (x2)	5	4	4	3
Local, authentic experience (x2)	5	2	4	3
Website and direct booking	2	5	3	2
Search visibility (SEO + ads)	2	5	3	1
Social content quality	3	4	4	2
Speed of reply (WhatsApp, email)	5	3	3	4
Offers for residents	1	3	2	4
Weighted total (max 45)	**33**	**32**	**31**	**25**

Weighted total = sum of scores, with "x2" factors counted twice (7 factors scored, 2 of them doubled = 9 units × 5 = maximum 45). Price is shown as information, not scored. Illustrative.

How to read it: Kaz Corail wins on reviews and local experience, the two factors customers weight most, so they belong at the heart of positioning. It loses on website, booking and search visibility, a big part of the 12-month plan. Nobody combines a local experience with strong resident offers (an opportunity), and bidding against big resorts on generic terms such as "hotel Mauritius" is a fight to avoid. In B2B, useful factors include specialisation, response time, price transparency, local expertise (MRA, VAT, payroll) and testimonials.

Perceptual map

Draw two axes that matter to customers, such as **price** and **experience** (standard to local and personal), and place each competitor honestly. Here, Kaz Corail and Hotel B are local and personal at mid-to-high prices, Villa C is cheaper, and the resort is expensive and standard. The empty space, local and personal at a resident-friendly price, inspired the winter offer.

PART C

Strategic choices

Who you serve, what you promise and how you say it: segmentation, personas, value and positioning

SECTION 12

Segmentation and targeting

No business can serve everyone well with a small budget. Segmentation splits the market into groups of people with similar needs; targeting chooses the groups you will focus on this year. Together with positioning (Section 15) they form STP: Segmentation, Targeting, Positioning.

Ways to segment a market

Basis	Examples	Good for
Demographic	Age, gender, income, family stage, profession	Easy ad targeting; often too broad on its own
Geographic	Region (north, Plaines Wilhems, Rodrigues), resident vs tourist, source country	Local businesses, tourism
Behavioural	First-time vs repeat buyer, occasion (birthday, wedding), channel used, spend level	Messages and offers that match the moment
Needs-based	What they want to achieve: save time, look good, feel safe, save money	Positioning and product design
Psychographic	Values, lifestyle, attitudes (eco-minded, status-seeking, adventurous)	Brand tone and creative
Firmographic (B2B)	Sector, company size, number of staff, growth stage, decision makers	B2B targeting on LinkedIn and in sales

Good segments are MASDA

A segment is useful if it is **Measurable** (you can estimate its size), **Accessible** (you can reach it with your channels), **Substantial** (big or valuable enough), **Differentiable** (it reacts differently from other segments) and **Actionable** (you can build an offer for it).

Scoring segments to choose your targets

Segment (Kaz Corail)	Size and value	Growth	Fit with strengths	Competition	Reach cost	Total /25
European couples 30–55	5	3	5	3	3	**19**
Mauritian couples, winter weekends	3	4	4	4	5	**20**
Indian honeymooners	3	5	3	3	2	**16**
Families with young children	4	3	2	2	3	**14**
Business travellers	2	2	2	3	3	**12**

5 = very attractive. Illustrative scores.

The scores are a discussion tool, not a formula. Kaz Corail chooses **European couples as the primary target** (they bring most revenue and match its strengths), **Mauritian couples as a secondary target** for the winter low season (high score, cheap to reach, fills empty rooms), and Indian honeymooners as a **test segment** with 10% of the budget. Families and business travellers are not targeted this year.

Targeting strategies

- **Concentrated:** one segment, one offer. Best for small budgets and new businesses.

- **Differentiated:** two or three segments, each with its own message and offer. The usual choice for an established SME.
- **Undifferentiated:** one message for everyone. Rarely works for small businesses; reserved for mass products.

> **In Mauritius:** the resident market is small, so a business that targets only Mauritians often reaches the same people again and again. Many hotels, restaurants and leisure businesses combine a tourist segment (bigger, seasonal) with a resident segment (smaller, fills the low season and creates word of mouth). Make sure your plan sizes each one with real numbers, for example Meta's estimated audience size for your targeting.

SECTION 13

Personas and jobs-to-be-done

A segment is a group on a spreadsheet. A persona turns it into a believable person, so that everyone who writes an ad, a post or an email has the same customer in mind. Jobs-to-be-done adds the most important question: what is this person trying to achieve?

What a useful persona contains

Field	Persona 1: Sophie and Marc (primary)	Persona 2: Priya and Kevin (secondary)
Who	French couple, 42 and 45, Lyon, both work, no children at home	Mauritian couple, 31 and 34, Quatre Bornes, both work, one child
Situation	Plan one long-haul trip a year; 10–14 nights	Want a weekend break without travelling abroad; book 2–3 weeks ahead
Job to be done	"Help us rest and discover the real island, not a copy of every resort."	"Give us two days to feel like tourists in our own country, without breaking the budget."
Pains	Hidden fees, impersonal resorts, fear of cyclones, slow replies	Prices quoted in euros, packages made for tourists, finding a babysitter
Gains	A host who gives local tips, great food, quiet beach, a story to tell	Half-board deal, late check-out, a kids' club option, a good photo spot
Where they look	Google, booking sites, Instagram, travel blogs, YouTube	Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp groups, friends' recommendations
Language	French first, English possible	French and Kreol on social; English or French for booking
Decision trigger	Reviews, photos of rooms and food, best direct price	A clear Rs price, a limited-time offer, a friend's story
Objection to answer	"Is it worth the long flight in February?"	"Is it really cheaper than a hotel promotion on Facebook?"

Fictional personas built from (illustrative) interviews and review mining.

Jobs-to-be-done (JTBD)

The jobs-to-be-done idea, popularised by Clayton Christensen, says that people "hire" a product to make progress in a particular situation. The classic way to write it is: **"When [situation], I want to [motivation], so I can [expected outcome]."**

Business	Job statement	What it changes in the strategy
Cake shop	When my child’s birthday is coming, I want a cake that matches the party theme, so I can make the day special without stress.	Sell themes and peace of mind (delivery, deadlines), not just flavours
Accounting firm	When MRA deadlines approach, I want someone to handle VAT and payroll correctly, so I can focus on running my company without fear of penalties.	Lead with risk reduction and calm, not with "cheap bookkeeping"
Gym	When I start a new job, I want a routine that fits my commute, so I can get fit without losing my evenings.	Opening hours and location in the message

> **Tip:** jobs have three layers: **functional** (get the books done), **emotional** (feel in control) and **social** (look professional to the bank). Strong brands answer all three.

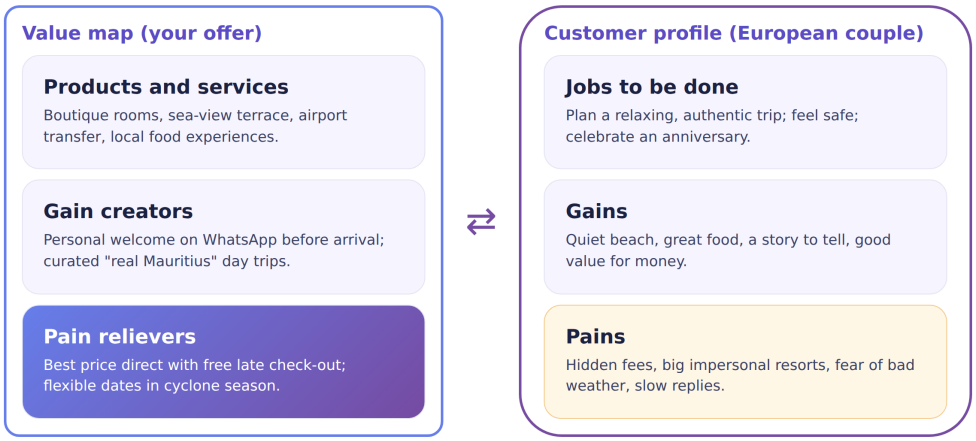
SECTION 14

The value proposition canvas

A value proposition explains why the target customer should choose you rather than an alternative. The value proposition canvas, developed by Strategyzer, helps you design it by matching your offer to the customer’s jobs, pains and gains.

The value proposition canvas

Match what you offer (left) to what the customer is trying to get done (right). Based on Strategyzer’s canvas.



Fictional example. A strong fit means your top 3 pain relievers and gain creators answer the customer’s top 3 pains and gains.

How to fill the canvas in 45 minutes

1. **Start on the right (customer).** List the persona’s jobs, pains and gains from your research. Rank them from most to least important.
2. **Then the left (your offer).** List your products and services, then how they relieve each pain and create each gain.
3. **Look for fit.** Draw lines between the top pains and gains and your relievers and creators. Unmatched top pains are product or service gaps; features that match nothing are not selling points.
4. **Compare with competitors.** Using your matrix, mark which relievers and creators competitors also offer. What is left is your differentiator.
5. **Write the value proposition** in one sentence, then test it with 5 customers or in a small ad test.

From canvas to value proposition

Element	Kaz Corail (European couples)	ClearBooks (SME owners)
Headline	The real Mauritius, with a host who knows you by name	VAT, payroll and accounts done right, every month
Sub-headline	28 rooms, a sea-view terrace and Creole cooking, 5 minutes from Grand Baie	A fixed monthly fee for companies with 2–50 staff, in English or French
3 benefits	Personal local tips on WhatsApp · Best price and late check-out when you book direct · Flexible dates in cyclone season	Deadlines never missed · One dedicated accountant · Clear dashboard of your numbers
Proof	4.7 on Google from 600+ reviews (illustrative)	Clients in retail, tourism and services; certified staff (illustrative)

The four tests of a strong value proposition

- **Relevant:** it answers a top job, pain or gain of the target persona.
- **Specific:** it says what, for whom and how much, without vague words like "quality" or "excellence".
- **Different:** a competitor could not use the same sentence.
- **Credible:** it is backed by proof: reviews, numbers, guarantees, certifications, demonstrations.

SECTION 15

Writing your positioning statement

Positioning is the place you want to occupy in the target customer’s mind compared with the alternatives. The positioning statement is an internal sentence, not a slogan: it guides every message, offer, design and channel choice.

The classic template

```
For [target customer]
who [need or job to be done],
[brand] is the [category / frame of reference]
that [main benefit / point of difference],
because [reasons to believe].
```

Two examples

> **Kaz Corail:** For couples who want to experience the real Mauritius rather than a standard resort, Kaz Corail is the boutique hotel in Grand Baie that makes you feel like a guest of a local family, because our team of 22 islanders hosts only 28 rooms, cooks Creole recipes daily and shares personal tips before and during your stay.

> **ClearBooks Advisory:** For owners of Mauritian companies with 2 to 50 staff who worry about VAT, payroll and MRA deadlines, ClearBooks is the accounting partner that takes compliance off your mind for a fixed monthly fee, because a dedicated, certified accountant handles your filings and shares a live dashboard of your numbers.

Points of parity and points of difference

Points of parity are what customers expect from anyone in the category (clean rooms, Wi-Fi, accurate accounts). You must match them, but they do not win customers. **Points of difference** are the 1–3 reasons people choose you. Position on a difference that matters to your target, that you can deliver every day, and that competitors cannot easily copy.

Positioning approach	Example	Risk
Price / value	"Best value boutique stay in the north"	Price wars; hard to defend for small firms
Quality / premium	"The most refined service in Grand Baie"	Must be delivered every time; expensive
Specialist / niche	"Accounting for tourism businesses"	Smaller market, but strong word of mouth
Experience / emotion	"Feel like a local"	Needs consistent content and service
Convenience / speed	"Cakes delivered in 24 hours"	Operations must keep the promise
Values / purpose	"Zero single-use plastic hotel"	Claims must be true and provable (no greenwashing)

Testing your positioning

- ☐ Would our target customers recognise themselves in the "for" and "who"?
- ☐ Is the difference important to them (from research), not just to us?
- ☐ Can a competitor say the same sentence? If yes, sharpen it.
- ☐ Can we prove the "because" today?
- ☐ Does it fit with our competitor matrix and perceptual map?
- ☐ Can every staff member explain it in their own words?

SECTION 16

Brand and messaging architecture

Once the positioning is clear, you organise what you say into a messaging architecture: one core message, a few pillars that support it, and proof points for each. It keeps ads, posts, emails and staff conversations consistent across channels and languages.

The messaging house

Level	Kaz Corail example
Brand promise (roof)	The real Mauritius, with a host who knows you by name
Pillar 1: Local hosts	Proof: personal WhatsApp tips before arrival; staff recommendations; guest stories
Pillar 2: Creole table	Proof: daily Creole menu; cooking class; local suppliers named on the menu
Pillar 3: Book direct, stay better	Proof: best rate guarantee; late check-out; flexible dates in cyclone season
Foundation: brand personality and tone	Warm, relaxed, proud of the island, never pushy; French and English, Kreol touches in social

Message by persona and stage

Stage	Sophie and Marc (Europe)	Priya and Kevin (residents)
See	Reel: "A day with our host Ravi in the north"	Reel in Kreol: "Weekend kot nou: Rs 6,900 for two, half-board"
Think	Blog: "Mauritius in February: what to expect"	Carousel: "What is included in the winter escape"
Do	Search ad: "Kaz Corail official site: best rate + late check-out"	WhatsApp message: "3 weekends left in July, reserve now"
Care	Email after stay: "Your recipe for the fish vindaye we served"	Review request and "bring friends" offer

Rs prices in this guide are illustrative.

Tone of voice and languages

- Write 3–4 tone words with "but not" limits: **warm but not familiar**, **confident but not arrogant**, **simple but not childish**.
- Decide the language per channel and audience: for example English and French on the website, French and Kreol on Facebook for residents, English for Indian and South African markets.
- Create a short **brand kit**: logo use, colours, fonts, photo style, words to use and avoid. Week 13 showed how to give it to AI tools so generated content stays on brand.
- Translate meaning, not words: a pun in French rarely works in English; ask a native speaker to adapt.

PART D

The plan

Channels, budget, the Mauritian calendar, measurement and a roadmap of tests for the year

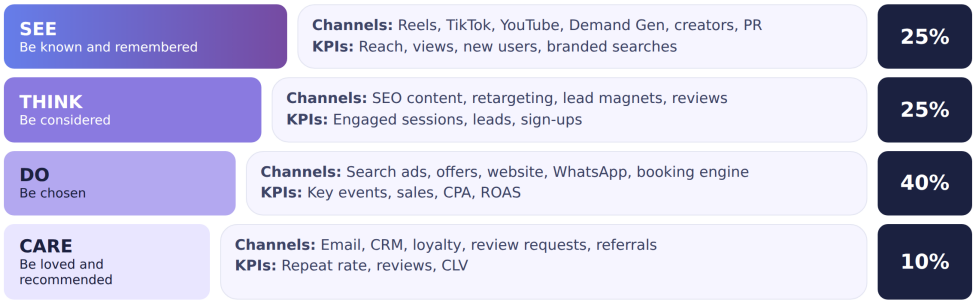
SECTION 17

Choosing channels: fit, stage and mix

With targets, personas and positioning decided, you choose the channels. This is where Weeks 3 to 16 come together. The question is not "which channels are good?" but "which channels reach our target at the right stage, within our budget and skills?"

Channel plan by stage: See, Think, Do, Care

Each stage has a different job, different channels, different KPIs and its own share of the budget



Budget shares are an illustrative starting point for a business with some awareness already; a new brand needs more in See, a mature brand more in Care.

Owned, earned and paid media

Type	What it is	Examples	Strength	Weakness
Owned	Assets you control	Website, email list, WhatsApp list, blog, app, social profiles	Low running cost, builds long-term value	Slow to grow
Earned	Attention others give you	Reviews, press, shares, word of mouth, organic search rankings, creators who mention you freely	Highly trusted	Hard to control or predict
Paid	Attention you buy	Google Ads, Meta Ads, TikTok, LinkedIn, display, paid creators	Fast, scalable, measurable	Stops when you stop paying

A healthy strategy uses paid media to feed owned media (every campaign grows the email or WhatsApp list and the retargeting audience) and earned media (good experiences generate reviews). The goal over time is to depend less on paid media for each sale.

Channel–objective fit

Channel (week)	Best for	Typical role	Watch out
SEO and content (3, 4)	Think, Do	Capture demand at low long-term cost	3–6 months before results
Social organic (5)	See, Care	Community, proof, brand personality	Low organic reach without ads
Google Search Ads (6, 7)	Do	Capture people searching now	Expensive generic keywords
Meta Ads (8)	See, Think, Do	Create demand, retarget, lead and message ads	Creative fatigue in a small market
Display, video, YouTube (9)	See	Awareness and reach at low cost per view	Hard to measure direct sales
Email, CRM, WhatsApp (10, 15)	Think, Care	Nurture, repeat purchase, referrals	Needs consent and a list
LinkedIn (organic and ads)	See, Think (B2B)	Reach decision makers by job and company	Higher cost per click
Creators and PR	See, Think	Trust and reach in a new segment	Disclosure rules, fit with brand
Website and CRO (2, 16)	Do	Turn traffic into results	Weak site wastes all other spend

Rules for choosing the mix

1. **Fix the base first:** tracking (GA4 key events), a website that converts on mobile, a Google Business Profile and a way to capture contacts. Without them, extra traffic is wasted.
2. **Capture existing demand before creating new demand:** branded and high-intent search, retargeting and email usually return the most per rupee.
3. **Go where your personas are:** use your research, not trends. A B2B firm may need LinkedIn and Google; a cake shop needs Instagram, Facebook and WhatsApp.
4. **Fewer channels, done well:** for a small team, 3–4 active channels is plenty. Each must have an owner, a content plan and a KPI.
5. **Balance short and long term:** keep some budget for awareness and SEO even when sales are urgent, or the pipeline dries up in six months.

The funnel and the flywheel

The funnel reminds you that people drop out at each stage, so you need enough at the top. The flywheel reminds you that satisfied customers (Care) bring new ones through reviews and referrals, reducing future acquisition costs. In a small island, the flywheel is especially powerful: plan explicit actions for reviews, referrals and repeat business.

SECTION 18

Budgeting methods

There is no perfect way to set a marketing budget. Most businesses combine two or three methods: a top-down figure the business can afford, checked against a bottom-up calculation of what the objectives need.

Method	How it works	Pros	Cons
% of revenue	Marketing = a fixed share of current or expected revenue	Simple, affordable, easy to approve	Spending falls when sales fall, exactly when you may need more
Objective and task	List the tasks needed to reach each objective, cost them, add them up	Linked to goals; easy to justify	Needs good estimates of costs and conversion rates
Competitive parity	Spend roughly what competitors spend	Avoids being outspent	Competitors may be wrong; their goals differ
Affordable / what is left	Whatever remains after other costs	No financial risk	No link to opportunity; marketing always under-funded
Test and scale	Start small, increase budget where CPA or ROAS meets the target	Learns fast, low waste	Needs tracking and patience

Benchmarks: use with care

Gartner’s 2026 CMO Spend Survey found that large companies, mostly in North America and Europe, spent an average of **7.8% of company revenue** on marketing in 2026 (7.7% in 2025), and about 15% of marketing budgets went to AI. Small businesses in Mauritius often spend much less, commonly a few per cent of revenue, and it varies widely by sector: a new e-commerce brand may invest far more than an established B2B firm with long-term clients. Treat any percentage as a starting point to discuss, not a rule.

Objective-and-task in practice

Work backwards from the SMART goal using your funnel rates (Weeks 11–12). Example for ClearBooks Advisory (illustrative):

Step	Calculation	Result
New clients needed	Goal for 2027	30
Win rate SQL → client	25% (from last year’s CRM)	30 ÷ 0.25 = 120 SQLs
Lead → SQL rate	30%	120 ÷ 0.30 = 400 leads
Target cost per lead (CPL)	Blended across LinkedIn, Google and content	Rs 1,000
Media and content budget	400 leads × Rs 1,000	**Rs 400,000**
Plus tools, design, events, testing reserve	Costed task by task	Rs 200,000
Total marketing budget		**Rs 600,000**
Check: value of new business	30 clients × Rs 90,000 average annual fee	Rs 2,700,000 in year one

Cost per SQL = Rs 600,000 ÷ 120 = Rs 5,000 all-in; media only Rs 400,000 ÷ 120 ≈ Rs 3,333, within the Rs 4,000 target in Section 4.

Tip: split your budget into three buckets, a rule of thumb many teams use: about **70% for proven activities**, **20% for promising ones** you want to scale, and **10% for experiments**. The test bucket funds your testing roadmap (Section 22) and stops new ideas from eating the budget of what already works.

Budget for the hidden costs: content production (photos, video, design), tools and subscriptions, VAT now charged by foreign platforms (Section 5), agency or freelancer fees, and staff time. Media spend is often only half of the real cost of a campaign.

SECTION 19

A budget allocation example in rupees

Kaz Corail (fictional) has room revenue of about Rs 60 million a year. The owners approve a digital marketing budget of Rs 1.8 million for 2027, 3% of revenue, after checking it against the objective-and-task calculation below. All figures are illustrative.

Does the budget make sense? The business case

Item	Calculation	Amount
Extra direct room revenue targeted	Rs 18m – Rs 12m	Rs 6,000,000
Commission saved on bookings moved from booking sites	About 70% of the extra revenue was booked via sites before, at an assumed 18% commission: Rs 6m × 70% × 18%	Rs 756,000
Digital marketing budget	Agreed	Rs 1,800,000
Revenue per rupee of marketing (on the extra direct revenue)	Rs 6,000,000 ÷ Rs 1,800,000	about 3.3

The budget pays back through extra direct revenue and saved commission, and it builds assets (list, reviews, SEO) that keep working in 2028.

Allocation by channel

Each line has a stage (Section 17) and a short note on how the money is used.

Line	Stage	Annual (Rs)	Share	Notes
Google Ads: brand, hotel and search campaigns	Do	450,000	25%	Protect brand searches; long-tail terms; Week 6–7 methods
Meta Ads: video, retargeting, resident offers	See, Think, Do	360,000	20%	Reels and carousel ads; Advantage+ with good creative inputs
YouTube and Demand Gen video	See	90,000	5%	Europe and India, before the booking windows
Content production: photo, video, creators' fees	All	270,000	15%	Two shoots a year plus monthly Reels
SEO, website and booking engine improvements	Think, Do	180,000	10%	Content, technical fixes, CRO tests
Email, CRM and WhatsApp tools	Care	90,000	5%	CRM, email platform, review tool

Line	Stage	Annual (Rs)	Share	Notes
Analytics and research tools	Control	54,000	3%	Paid tool months during planning, consent tool
Creators, PR and partnerships	See, Think	126,000	7%	Local creators for the resident segment
Testing reserve	All	180,000	10%	Indian honeymoon test, new formats (Section 22)
Total		**1,800,000**	**100%**	

Phasing by quarter

Spend follows demand and booking windows, not the calendar. Europeans book the October–December peak months in advance, while residents book winter weekends only two or three weeks ahead.

Quarter	Share	Amount (Rs)	Focus
Q1 (Jan–Mar)	20%	360,000	Booking engine launch, SEO content, Easter offers for residents, European summer bookings
Q2 (Apr–Jun)	25%	450,000	Winter Escapes campaign for residents; Europe and India campaigns for the October–December season
Q3 (Jul–Sep)	30%	540,000	Peak booking window for the high season; school-holiday family weekends tested; creator content
Q4 (Oct–Dec)	25%	450,000	Last-minute and festive offers, repeat-guest email, reviews, planning for 2028

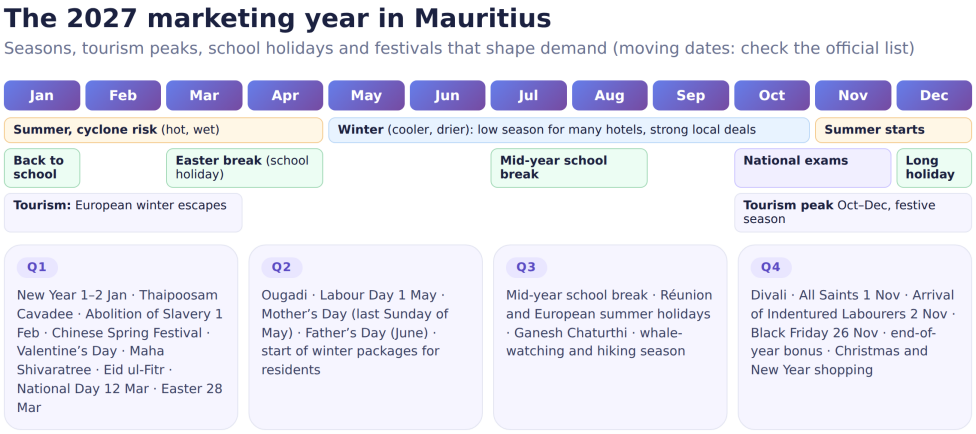
Quarter totals add up to Rs 1,800,000.

> **In Mauritius:** budget lines from foreign platforms (Google, Meta, LinkedIn, TikTok, most software) are billed in foreign currency or with exchange-rate effects, and now with Mauritian VAT where it applies. Add a contingency of about 5–10% to those lines, and review real costs each quarter. In October 2026 one US dollar was worth about Rs 47.

SECTION 20

The annual marketing calendar for Mauritius

A 12-month plan needs a calendar that reflects how demand moves in Mauritius: seasons, the tourism year, school holidays, religious and cultural festivals, public holidays and retail moments. Plan campaigns 4–8 weeks before each moment, since people research before they buy.



Key dates for 2027 to plan around

Fixed public holidays: New Year (1 and 2 January), Abolition of Slavery (1 February), National Day (12 March), Labour Day (1 May), All Saints Day (1 November; in some years Assumption on 15 August is the holiday instead), Arrival of Indentured Labourers (2 November) and Christmas (25 December). Festivals that move each year follow the lunar or Hindu calendars; expected 2027 dates are shown below.

Moment (2027)	Expected date	Marketing angle
Thaipoosam Cavadee	Late January	Respectful greetings; food and travel businesses adapt hours
Chinese Spring Festival	Around 6 February	Gifts, restaurants, decoration, family meals
Valentine's Day	14 February (not a holiday)	Restaurants, florists, cake shops, hotels: couples offers
Maha Shivaratree	Early March	Greetings; avoid insensitive promotions
Eid ul-Fitr	Around 10 March (moon sighting)	Clothing, food, gifts, family gatherings
Easter	28 March	Long weekend, school break: local stays, family outings
Ougadi	Early April	New year for the Telugu community: greetings, food
Mother's Day	Last Sunday of May (30 May)	Gifts, restaurants, spas, flowers, cakes
Father's Day	Mid-June	Gifts, electronics, restaurants
Ganesh Chaturthi	Early September	Greetings; sweets and food

Moment (2027)	Expected date	Marketing angle
Divali	Around late October	Major retail and sweets season, lights, gifts, clothing
Black Friday	26 November	E-commerce and retail promotions (Week 16)
End-of-year bonus and festive season	December	Biggest shopping period; local holidays; hotel weekend packages

The list of public holidays for 2027 is published officially by the Government of Mauritius, usually towards the end of 2026. Check the official list before you fix campaign dates; festival dates may shift by a day.

Seasonal patterns to consider

- **Tourism:** European travellers come mostly during their autumn and winter (roughly October to April), with the October–December period and Easter among the busiest. Our winter (May–September) is quieter for many hotels, so resident offers fill rooms.
- **Weather:** summer (November to April) is hot and humid and brings cyclone risk, mostly from January to March. Plan flexible messages and a "pause" process for campaigns during cyclone warnings.
- **Schools:** the school year runs from January to November, with breaks around Easter and in the middle of the year, and a long holiday in December and January. Back-to-school in January is a key moment for retail and education.
- **Pay cycles:** many salaries are paid at the end of the month; a 13th-month end-of-year bonus boosts December spending. Promotions near payday often perform better.
- **B2B:** activity slows in late December and January; budgets are set in the months before the financial year; tax and VAT deadlines create demand for advisory services.

From calendar to campaign plan

Mark three kinds of activity on your 12-month Gantt chart (worksheet in Section 29): **always-on** activity that runs all year (SEO, brand search, retargeting, email newsletter), **campaign bursts** tied to moments (4–8 weeks each), and **projects** with a start and end date (new website, CRM set-up, photo shoot).

SECTION 21

Measurement framework and dashboards

Control is the last letter of SOSTAC and the one most often forgotten. A measurement framework says, before you start, what you will measure, where the data comes from, who looks at it and when. Week 11 taught you the tracking; Week 18 will teach you to report and tell stories with data.



The measurement framework table

Objective	KPI	Target 2027	Source	Frequency	Owner
Direct revenue	Direct room revenue	Rs 18m	Booking engine + GA4 purchase revenue	Monthly	Owner
Traffic	Website sessions	100,000	GA4	Monthly	Marketing
Conversion	Booking conversion rate	2.0%	GA4 key events ÷ sessions	Monthly	Marketing
Efficiency	Cost per direct booking	Under Rs 900	Ads + GA4	Weekly	Agency
Efficiency	ROAS on paid media	4.0 or more	Google Ads, Meta, GA4	Weekly	Agency
Reputation	Google rating and new reviews	4.7+, 20 new a month	Google Business Profile	Monthly	Front office
Loyalty	Repeat guest share	15%	CRM	Quarterly	Owner

Dashboard plan

- **One page, three layers:** top = North Star and 3–5 KPIs against target; middle = channel performance; bottom = notes and actions.
- **Build it in Data Studio** (Google’s free dashboard tool, called Looker Studio until April 2026), connected to GA4, Google Ads, Search Console and a Google Sheet for offline data such as bookings by phone.
- **Use targets and comparisons:** every number shows the target and the change versus last period or last year.

- **Different views for different people:** the owner needs revenue and profit, the marketer needs channel and campaign detail.

The review rhythm

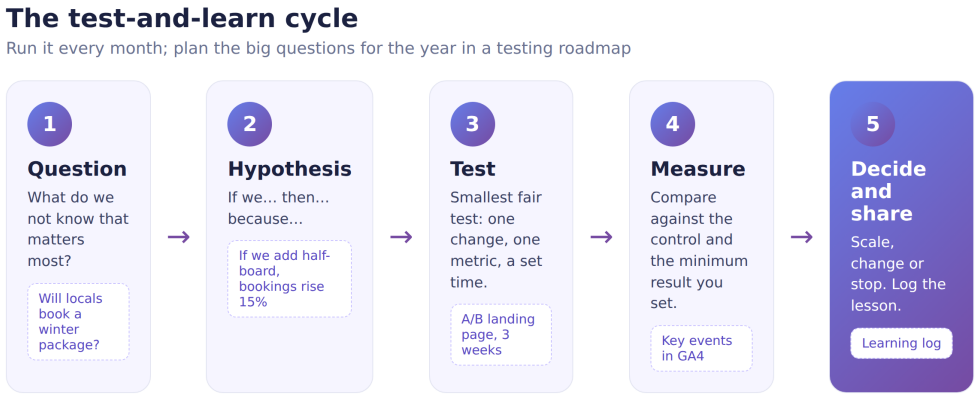
Meeting	When	Questions	Decisions
Weekly check (15 min)	Monday	Anything broken? Any campaign far off target?	Pause, fix, shift small budgets
Monthly review (1 hour)	First week of the month	Are KPIs on track? What did tests teach us?	Adjust tactics and next month's plan
Quarterly business review (half day)	End of each quarter	Are we reaching objectives? Has the situation changed?	Re-allocate budget, update OKRs, change strategy if needed

> **Tip:** agree how you will measure results **before** launching: which attribution model you use in GA4 (data-driven by default), how you count phone and WhatsApp bookings, and what counts as a qualified lead. Changing the rules halfway through makes year-on-year comparisons meaningless.

SECTION 22

The testing and learning roadmap

A strategy is a set of educated guesses. A testing roadmap turns the biggest uncertainties into planned experiments, so that by the end of the year you know more about your customers than your competitors do.



Writing a good hypothesis

Use the format **"If we [change], then [metric] will [improve by X], because [insight]."** Example: "If we show the total price for two people in rupees, including breakfast, then the resident landing page conversion rate will rise from 2% to 3%, because interviews show residents distrust prices in euros and per person."

Example roadmap for the year

Quarter	Test	Metric	Decision rule
Q1	New booking engine vs old (before/after, then A/B on the landing page)	Booking conversion rate	Keep if conversion rises by at least 0.3 points
Q1	Kreol vs French ad copy for residents	Cost per landing page view and per booking	Scale the winner
Q2	Half-board vs room-only winter offer	Bookings and revenue per booking	Choose higher revenue, not just more bookings
Q2	Indian honeymoon market: Meta and Google, Rs 60,000	Cost per booking vs Europe	Continue only if under Rs 1,500 per booking
Q3	Creator video vs hotel-made Reels	Cost per 1,000 reached, saves, bookings	Shift content budget to the better format
Q4	Repeat-guest email with or without a perk	Repeat bookings	Keep the perk if incremental revenue exceeds its cost

Illustrative test plan for Kaz Corail.

Rules for fair tests

- Change **one thing** at a time and keep a control (what you do today).
- Decide the **success metric and minimum result** before starting.
- Run tests long enough to cover a full week or booking cycle, and get enough results; small samples in a small market can mislead (Weeks 7 and 16 explain significance).
- Use platform tools when available: Google Ads experiments, Meta A/B tests, email A/B tests.
- Keep a **learning log**: date, hypothesis, result, decision. It becomes one of the most valuable documents in the business.

PART E

Making it happen

People, partners and tools, governance and risk, AI for strategy, and presenting the plan to decision makers

SECTION 23

Resourcing: team, partners and tools

A plan without the people and tools to deliver it is a wish list. The Actions step of SOSTAC decides who does what: in-house staff, an agency, freelancers or a mix, supported by a realistic tool stack.

In-house, agency or freelancers?

Option	Best when	Advantages	Disadvantages
In-house	Marketing is core and continuous; you need deep product knowledge and fast reaction	Knows the business, available daily, builds internal skills	Salary and training costs; hard for one person to master every channel
Agency	You need several specialists, scale or strategic advice	Team of experts, tools included, experience from other clients	Monthly retainer; less product knowledge; you must manage them well
Freelancers	Specific tasks: photography, video, ads management, SEO, copywriting	Flexible, often cheaper, specialist skills	Coordination falls on you; availability varies
Hybrid (common for SMEs)	One in-house marketer coordinating freelancers or an agency for paid media	Ownership stays inside; specialists where needed	Requires clear briefs and roles

RACI: who decides what

For each key activity, name who is **Responsible** (does the work), **Accountable** (approves, one person only), **Consulted** (gives input) and **Informed** (kept up to date). Example: monthly ad budget changes: Responsible = agency, Accountable = marketing manager, Consulted = revenue manager, Informed = owner.

A realistic tool stack

Need	Free or low-cost options	Weeks
Analytics and dashboards	GA4, Google Search Console, Data Studio, Google Tag Manager	2, 11, 18
Research	Google Trends, Keyword Planner, Meta Ad Library, Ads Transparency Center, Semrush or Ubersuggest free	3, 17
Design and content	Canva, CapCut, smartphone, AI image and writing tools	4, 13, 14
Social and ads	Meta Business Suite, Ads Manager, Google Ads, LinkedIn Campaign Manager	5–9
Email, CRM and messaging	HubSpot free CRM, Mailchimp, Brevo or MailerLite, WhatsApp Business	10, 15
Automation	Zapier or Make free plans, native integrations	14, 15
Project management	Google Sheets, Trello, Notion, Asana free plans	17

> **Tip:** before buying a tool, write the job it must do, who will use it every week and what you will stop paying for. Paid tools billed in US dollars now often include Mauritian VAT (Section 5): add both to the budget.

In Mauritius: agencies in Mauritius commonly work on a monthly retainer plus media spend, while freelancers charge by project or by day. Ask for a written scope (deliverables, number of posts or campaigns, reporting, meetings), who owns the ad accounts and content (always your business), and a notice period. Never let an agency or freelancer create ad accounts or a GA4 property in their own name.

SECTION 24

Governance and risk management

Governance means the rules that keep marketing consistent, legal and under control as more people and tools get involved. Risk management means thinking in advance about what could go wrong and what you would do. Both are expected in a professional strategy.

Essential governance rules

- **Ownership of accounts:** the business owns every account (Google Ads, Meta Business portfolio, GA4, domain, social profiles, email tool) and gives others access with the lowest role they need. Two people in the business hold admin rights.
- **Approvals:** who approves budgets, new campaigns, offers, sensitive posts and replies to complaints. Write it down with response times.
- **Brand and content:** the brand kit and messaging house are the reference; AI-generated content is reviewed by a person before publication (Weeks 13–14).
- **Data protection:** consent wording on every form, a record of where personal data is stored, access limited to those who need it, a process for deletion requests and breaches (DPA 2017).
- **Documentation:** naming conventions for campaigns and UTMs, a tracking plan, an automation register (Week 15) and the learning log.

The risk register

List the main risks, rate likelihood and impact from 1 to 5, and agree a mitigation and an owner. Review it every quarter.

Risk	L	I	Mitigation	Owner
Cyclone or heavy-rain disruption during a campaign	3	4	Crisis message templates; pause rules for ads; flexible-date policy	Marketing manager
Tourism demand falls (airfares, economy)	3	4	Strengthen resident segment; monthly demand review; flexible budget	Owner
Ad account disabled or hacked	2	5	Two-step verification for all users, backup admins, policy checks	Agency + manager
Tracking breaks after website changes	3	3	Test key events after every release; weekly anomaly check	Web freelancer
Key person leaves	2	4	Documented processes, shared passwords manager, access by role	Owner
Negative review or social media crisis	3	3	Reply guidelines, escalation within 2 hours, never argue publicly	Front office
Platform cost increases (CPCs, VAT, exchange rate)	4	2	5–10% contingency; shift budget to owned channels over time	Marketing manager
Data protection breach	1	5	Limited access, secure tools, breach procedure and notification to the Data Protection Office	Owner

L = likelihood, I = impact (1 low to 5 high). Illustrative register for Kaz Corail.

Crisis and continuity plan in one paragraph

Write down in advance: who decides to pause campaigns, which messages to publish (in English and French), how to update the website and Google Business Profile, and how to handle bookings and cancellations. In Mauritius, cyclone warnings and heavy-rain alerts happen most summers; a prepared plan avoids ads promoting "beach days" during a warning.

SECTION 25

AI in strategy: research and scenarios

In Weeks 13 and 14 you used AI to create content and run campaigns. AI can also speed up strategic work: summarising research, generating hypotheses and stress-testing plans. It cannot replace your judgement, your customer conversations or verified data.

Where AI helps in the planning process

Task	How AI helps	Your checks
Desk research	Summarise long reports, find themes, suggest PESTLE points	Open the original source for every number; check the date
Review and survey analysis	Classify hundreds of reviews or answers into themes and sentiment	Read a sample yourself; remove personal data first
Competitor summaries	Compare competitors' public web pages and ads you paste in	Only public information; verify claims on the site
Personas and JTBD drafts	Turn interview notes into draft personas and job statements	Must match real research, not stereotypes
Positioning options	Generate 10 alternative positioning statements and taglines	Test with customers; check that competitors do not use them
Scenario planning	Build best, expected and worst cases from your assumptions	Assumptions come from your data; recalculate key numbers
Plan review	Ask AI to criticise your plan as a sceptical CFO would	Decide which comments are valid

A scenario planning prompt

```
You are a marketing strategist for a 28-room boutique hotel in Grand Baie, Mauritius.
Here are our 2026 results and 2027 assumptions: [paste table: sessions, conversion
rate, average booking value, budget by channel, CPA by channel].
Build three scenarios for 2027 (pessimistic, expected, optimistic). For each, list the
assumptions you changed, show the calculation of direct bookings and revenue step by
step, and suggest one action that protects us in the pessimistic case.
Do not invent market statistics. If you need data we did not provide, ask for it.
```

Scenario example (illustrative)

Scenario	Sessions	Conversion rate	Bookings	Avg value (Rs)	Direct revenue (Rs)
Pessimistic	85,000	1.6%	1,360	8,500	11,560,000
Expected	100,000	2.0%	2,000	9,000	18,000,000
Optimistic	115,000	2.3%	2,645	9,300	24,598,500

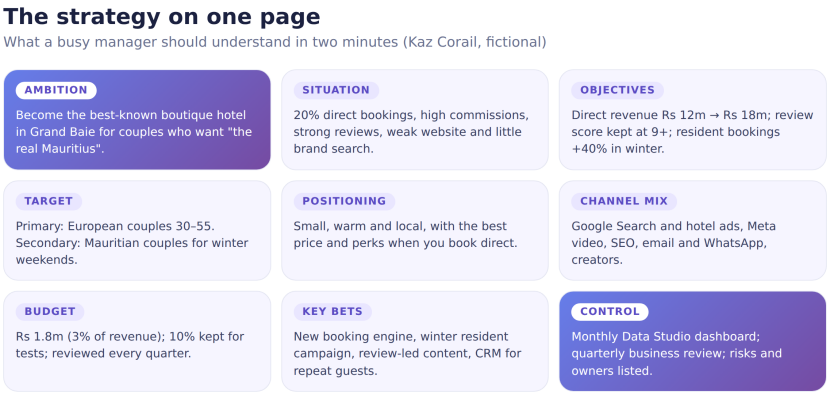
Check the AI's arithmetic yourself: sessions × conversion rate = bookings; bookings × average value = revenue.

Checks before you trust AI in strategy. AI tools can invent statistics, sources and competitors that do not exist, and their knowledge may be out of date. Never paste confidential data (guest lists, financial statements, client names) into a tool that is not approved by your business, and remove personal data to respect the DPA 2017. Label AI-assisted analysis in your document and keep the final decisions human.

SECTION 26

Presenting the strategy to stakeholders

A strategy only matters if decision makers approve it and the team understands it. Owners and managers have little time: lead with the answer, show the numbers, and make the decision you need from them explicit. Week 18 goes deeper into reporting and data storytelling.



A 12-slide structure

#	Slide	Content
1	The ask	What you want approved: budget, priorities, timing
2	Executive summary	The strategy on one page (above)
3	Where we are	3–4 key facts from the audit with numbers
4	Market and customers	PESTLE highlights and the main customer insight
5	Competition	Competitor matrix and perceptual map; where we can win
6	Objectives	SMART goals and the KPI tree
7	Target and positioning	Personas, positioning statement, value proposition
8	Channel plan	See-Think-Do-Care with channels and KPIs
9	Calendar	The 12-month Gantt with key campaigns
10	Budget and return	Allocation table and the business case
11	Measurement and risks	Dashboard, review rhythm, top 3 risks
12	Next 90 days	Actions, owners, dates; decisions needed today

Tips: start with the recommendation and the budget, then explain; show evidence (customer quotes, competitor screenshots, real GA4 and sales numbers); say which numbers are assumptions and how you will test them; and give each slide a headline that states the conclusion ("Mobile visitors book half as often as desktop visitors"), not a topic ("Website data").

PART F

Put it to work

Two case studies, FAQ, exercises,
your 12-Month Strategy Document,
worksheets, checklists and glossary

SECTION 27

Two case studies: a hotel and a B2B firm

The two fictional businesses used in this guide, brought together as complete strategies. Use them as models for the level of detail expected in your own document. All numbers are illustrative.

Case study 1 (B2C): Kaz Corail Boutique Hotel, Grand Baie

SOSTAC step	Summary
Situation	28 rooms, Rs 60m room revenue, 80% booked via booking sites, excellent reviews, weak website (1.2% mobile booking rate), no CRM. Arrivals growing from India, Italy and Spain; inflation and airfares are risks.
Objectives	Direct room revenue Rs 12m → Rs 18m; resident bookings +40% May–September; rating 4.7+; repeat guest share 15%.
Strategy	Primary target European couples, secondary Mauritian couples in winter, test Indian honeymooners. Position: "the real Mauritius, with a host who knows you by name". Channel focus: Google Search and brand, Meta video and retargeting, SEO, email and WhatsApp.
Tactics	New booking engine (Q1); "Book direct, stay better" perks; Winter Escapes campaign (Q2); creator content (Q3); repeat-guest programme (Q4). Budget Rs 1.8m, phased 20/25/30/25%.
Actions	Marketing manager owns the plan; agency for paid media; freelancers for video and web; front office handles reviews and WhatsApp. Risk register with cyclone and demand scenarios.
Control	Monthly Data Studio dashboard; weekly ad checks; quarterly review; testing roadmap with 6 tests.

What made the plan convincing to the owners

- A clear business case: the budget is paid back by extra direct revenue and saved commission (Section 19).
- Honest analysis: the competitor matrix showed the website, not the brand, was the main weakness.
- Focus: two segments and four main channels instead of "everything everywhere".
- Quarterly checkpoints and a 10% test budget, so the owners could see learning before committing more money.

Case study 2 (B2B): ClearBooks Advisory, Ebène

ClearBooks is a 12-person accounting, payroll and VAT firm. Most clients came from the founder’s network. The new rules on VAT for foreign digital services and frequent tax changes create demand among small companies that lack in-house accountants.

SOSTAC step	Summary
Situation	140 clients; 1–2 new clients a month through referrals; website with no lead capture; LinkedIn page with 600 followers; competitors are larger firms (expensive) and freelancers (less reliable).
Objectives	30 new retainer clients in 2027; 400 leads, 120 SQLs, cost per SQL under Rs 4,000 (media); average annual fee Rs 90,000.

SOSTAC step	Summary
Strategy	Target owners and managers of companies with 2–50 staff in retail, tourism and services. Position: "compliance off your mind for a fixed monthly fee". Content-led: become the clearest local source on VAT and payroll changes.
Tactics	Monthly LinkedIn articles and short videos by the founder; Google Search ads on "accountant Mauritius", "payroll services Mauritius", "VAT registration"; a free "VAT and payroll compliance checklist" lead magnet; quarterly webinars; email nurture (Week 15); referral programme for clients.
Actions	Marketing coordinator (part-time) + freelance designer; founder records one video a month; HubSpot free CRM with lead scoring; sales SLA: call every SQL within one working day.
Control	Dashboard: leads by source, SQLs, cost per SQL, win rate, pipeline value; monthly pipeline review; tests on lead magnet titles and LinkedIn ad formats.

ClearBooks 12-month highlights

Quarter	Main activity	KPI focus
Q1	Website landing pages and lead magnet; CRM; Google Search campaigns	Leads, cost per lead
Q2	Webinar on the national Budget (usually June) and its effect on SMEs; LinkedIn lead ads	Webinar sign-ups, SQLs
Q3	Case studies from 3 clients; referral programme; retargeting	Win rate, referrals
Q4	Year-end planning webinar; offer for new-year onboarding; plan for 2028	Pipeline value for January

> **In Mauritius:** B2B buying in Mauritius is very relationship-based. Digital marketing does not replace meetings, chambers of commerce events and introductions; it makes them easier by giving decision makers proof (articles, case studies, reviews) before they meet you, and by keeping you in mind until they are ready.

SECTION 28

Frequently asked questions

How long should a 12-Month Strategy Document be?

For a small business, 12–20 pages plus appendices is enough. A one-page summary at the front is essential. Depth of analysis matters more than length.

What if the business has no data at all?

Use the first quarter to collect it: set up GA4 key events, record lead sources, interview customers. Set learning goals for Q1 and fix numeric targets at the first quarterly review.

How much should a small business spend on marketing?

There is no single answer. Combine what the business can afford (a % of revenue) with what the objectives need (objective and task), then start with tests and scale what works. Large-company benchmarks such as Gartner’s 7.8% are not targets for SMEs.

How often should we change the strategy?

Review it every quarter and rewrite it every year. Change tactics as often as the data tells you; change strategy only when the situation changes (new competitor, new law, a segment that does not respond).

Can AI write the strategy for us?

AI can draft sections, summarise research and challenge your thinking, but it does not know your customers or verified local data. Every fact must be checked and every decision made by people (Section 25).

How do we plan for cyclones and unexpected events?

Keep a risk register, prepared messages and pause rules, a flexible booking or cancellation policy where relevant, and a contingency budget to restart campaigns quickly after the event.

How does this week connect with the capstone?

Your 12-Month Strategy Document becomes the foundation of the Week 20 capstone. In Week 18 you will design the reporting and dashboard that track it.

SECTION 29

Exercises and the 12-Month Strategy Document

This week you complete three exercises. The first two build the analysis and the positioning; the third is your deliverable. Work on a real business: your own, your employer's, a client's or one you know well enough to research.

Exercise 17.1 · Competitive analysis (2–3 hours)

Using Sections 9–11, choose 3–5 competitors (direct, indirect, substitute), run the 90-minute research routine with at least four free tools (Meta Ad Library, Google Ads Transparency Center, Google Trends, Similarweb or Semrush or Ubersuggest, PageSpeed Insights, reviews), build a weighted competitor matrix with evidence, draw a perceptual map and write a SWOT with 4–6 points per box and three TOWS strategic options.

Exercise 17.2 · Strategic positioning (2 hours)

Using Sections 12–16, score 4–6 segments and choose your targets, write 2 personas with job statements, fill a value proposition canvas for the primary persona, write a positioning statement and test it with the checklist in Section 15, then build a messaging house with three pillars and proof points.

Exercise 17.3 · Your 12-Month Strategy Document (deliverable)

Bring everything together using the SOSTAC structure below. Include the worksheets on the following pages, completed, and cite your sources for every market fact.

Part	Content	Guide
0. Strategy on one page	Ambition, objectives, target, positioning, channel mix, budget, key bets, control	26
1. Situation analysis	PESTLE (Mauritius), customer research summary, digital audit scorecard, competitor matrix and perceptual map, SWOT and 5C	5–11
2. Objectives	Business and marketing objectives, 3–5 SMART goals, North Star metric and KPI tree	4, 21
3. Strategy	Segments and targets, personas and jobs-to-be-done, value proposition, positioning statement, messaging house	12–16

Part	Content	Guide
4. Channel plan	Owned / earned / paid, See-Think-Do-Care plan with channels, content and KPIs per stage	17
5. Budget	Method used, allocation table in Rs, quarterly phasing, business case	18–19
6. 12-month calendar	Gantt chart with always-on activity, campaign bursts and projects, linked to Mauritian dates	20
7. Measurement and testing	Measurement framework table, dashboard plan, review rhythm, testing roadmap	21–22
8. Actions and resources	Team and roles (RACI), partners, tool stack with costs, governance rules, risk register	23–24
9. Next 90 days	Detailed action list with owners and dates	26

Submit a link to your 12-Month Strategy Document (Google Doc or PDF, 12–20 pages plus appendices) on the learning platform, Module 17 exercises. It will feed your Week 20 capstone.

How your document will be assessed

Criterion	Weight
Quality and evidence of the situation analysis (market, customers, competitors)	25%
Clarity of objectives and KPIs (SMART, linked to the business)	15%
Strength of targeting, positioning and value proposition	20%
Coherence of the channel plan, calendar and budget	25%
Measurement, resources and risks; presentation quality	15%

WORKSHEETS

Copy-and-use worksheets

Copy these tables into your Google Doc or Sheet and complete them for your business.

1. SWOT

Strengths	Weaknesses
Opportunities	**Threats**

2. Competitor matrix (score 1–5, weight important factors x2)

Factor (weight)	Us	Competitor 1	Competitor 2	Competitor 3
Price level (information)				
Weighted total				

3. Persona

Field	Your persona
Name, age, place, situation	
Job to be done (When… I want to… so I can…)	
Pains	
Gains	
Where they look for information	
Languages	
Decision trigger	
Main objection	

4. Positioning statement

Element	Your answer
For (target customer)	
Who (need / job)	
Brand is the (category)	
That (main benefit / difference)	
Because (reasons to believe)	

5. Channel plan

Stage	Channels	Content / offer	KPI and target	Budget (Rs)
See				
Think				
Do				
Care				

6. 12-month Gantt chart (mark weeks or months with X)

Activity	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Always-on: SEO and content												
Always-on: brand search and retargeting												
Always-on: email / WhatsApp												
Campaign 1:												
Campaign 2:												
Campaign 3:												
Project:												
Quarterly review												

7. Budget table

Line	Stage	Q1 (Rs)	Q2 (Rs)	Q3 (Rs)	Q4 (Rs)	Total (Rs)	Share
Testing reserve							
Total							100%

8. KPI tree

Level	Metric	Baseline	Target	Source
North Star				
Driver 1				
Driver 2				
Sub-driver				
Sub-driver				
Efficiency KPI				

SECTION 30

Glossary and checklists

Strategy document checklist

- ☐ One-page summary at the front
- ☐ Every market fact has a recent source and date
- ☐ Customer insights come from real research (interviews, reviews, data)
- ☐ Competitor matrix with evidence; perceptual map; SWOT with TOWS options
- ☐ 3–5 SMART goals linked to a business objective; KPI tree
- ☐ 1 primary and at most 2 secondary target segments; what you will not do
- ☐ Positioning statement passes the six tests (Section 15)
- ☐ Channel plan by stage with an owner per channel
- ☐ Budget in Rs with method, phasing, testing reserve, VAT and contingency
- ☐ 12-month calendar with Mauritian moments and lead times
- ☐ Measurement framework, dashboard plan and review rhythm
- ☐ Team, tools, governance rules and risk register
- ☐ Next 90 days with owners and dates

Mistakes to avoid

Mistake	Do this instead
Starting with tactics ("we need TikTok")	Start with the situation and objectives; tactics come last
Targeting "everyone"	Choose segments and say no to others this year
A SWOT full of opinions	Back each point with evidence; turn it into TOWS options
Positioning nobody could disagree with	A sharp difference that matters to the target and can be proven
Budget with no business case	Show the return: revenue, saved costs, assets built
Ignoring local seasons and festivals	Build the Mauritian calendar into the plan, with lead times
Measuring likes instead of results	KPI tree from the North Star down
No owner, no review	Named owners, monthly reviews and a quarterly business review

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Strategy	The set of choices about objectives, target customers, positioning, channels and resources
Tactics	The specific actions that carry out the strategy (campaigns, content, offers)
SOSTAC	Situation, Objectives, Strategy, Tactics, Actions, Control: a planning framework by PR Smith
RACE	Plan, Reach, Act, Convert, Engage: a digital lifecycle framework from Smart Insights
See-Think-Do-Care	Audience stages by intent, from anyone who could buy to existing customers
PESTLE	Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, Environmental analysis
SWOT / TOWS	Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats / combining them into strategic options
5C	Company, Customers, Competitors, Collaborators, Context
SMART	Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound
OKR	Objectives and Key Results: a goal plus 2–4 measurable results, often set quarterly
KPI	Key performance indicator: a measure that shows progress towards an objective
North Star metric	The single metric that best reflects value for the business
Leading / lagging indicator	A metric that moves first and predicts results / one that confirms results later
STP	Segmentation, Targeting, Positioning
Persona	A research-based portrait of a typical customer in a target segment
Jobs-to-be-done	The progress a customer wants to make in a given situation
Value proposition	Why the target customer should choose you rather than an alternative
Positioning statement	Internal sentence defining target, need, category, difference and proof
Perceptual map	A chart placing competitors on two dimensions customers care about
Owned / earned / paid media	Channels you control / attention others give you / attention you buy
Objective-and-task	Budgeting by costing the tasks needed to reach each objective
70-20-10	Rule of thumb: budget for proven, promising and experimental activity
RACI	Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed: who does and decides what
Risk register	List of risks with likelihood, impact, mitigation and owner
Gantt chart	A timeline chart showing activities across weeks or months